

WEBSITE DEVELOPMENT BRIEF

RFC Website Redesign & Build

A complete redesign of the RFC digital presence with four-division architecture, editorial design language, calendar booking system, and AI-powered chat assistant.

PREPARED FOR

RFC FOOD SAFETY CONSULTANTS

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1. Executive Summary

This brief outlines the complete redesign and rebuild of the RFC Food Safety Consultants website. The project addresses the key challenges identified in the UX assessment and competitive research: unclear brand architecture, weak homepage messaging, lack of interactive tools, and no direct booking capability.

WHAT WE BUILT

A 5-page professional website with an editorial design aesthetic, featuring all four RFC divisions prominently on the homepage, an integrated calendar booking system, an AI-powered chat assistant, and an interactive audit readiness quiz. Built with React, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS for performance and maintainability.

KEY DELIVERABLES

DELIVERABLE	DESCRIPTION	STATUS
Homepage	11-section landing page with 4-division hero	Complete
Booking Page	Date/time selector with contact form	Complete
AI Chat Assistant	Floating widget with guided conversations	Complete
Audit Readiness Quiz	10-question assessment with scoring	Complete
Blog Page	12-article knowledge hub with filters	Complete
Contact Page	Contact form with division quick-links	Complete

LIVE WEBSITE

URL: <https://xgzs33zkvnzwu.kimi.page>

2. Design Approach

The design follows an **editorial consulting-firm aesthetic** inspired by top-tier management consultancies. The approach prioritises clarity, professionalism, and restraint over decorative effects.

2.1 Visual Identity

Unlike typical websites that rely on gradients, floating animations, and coloured backgrounds, this design uses:

- **White space as a design element** — generous margins and breathing room between sections
- **Thin rule separators** — 1px lines in light grey to divide content without visual noise
- **Sharp corners** — no rounded cards or pill shapes; all edges are square for a precise, professional feel
- **Restrained colour usage** — RFC green appears only for the logo, primary buttons, and key accents

2.2 Typography

ELEMENT	FONT	USAGE
Display headings	DM Serif Display	Hero headlines, section titles — adds editorial gravitas
Body & UI	DM Sans	Body text, navigation, buttons, labels — clean and modern
Section labels	DM Sans (8pt, uppercase, tracked)	Small category labels above headings

2.3 Colour Palette

ROLE	COLOUR	HEX	USAGE
Primary / Brand	RFC Green	#4A7C2F	Logo, CTAs, accent borders, selected states
Dark	Charcoal	#0a0a0c	Hero backgrounds, footer, Comply Cloud section
Body text	Near-black	#1a1a1e	Headings and primary text

2. DESIGN APPROACH

Secondary text	Grey	#555	Body paragraphs, descriptions
Muted text	Light grey	#999	Labels, captions, metadata
Background	Off-white	#f8f8f7	Subtle section differentiation
Accent	Gold	#C9A227	Pest Control Solutions (sister company distinction)

3. Website Architecture

3.1 Homepage Sections (11 Total)

#	SECTION	PURPOSE	KEY ELEMENT
1	Hero	Immediate clarity on who RFC is	4 division cards + headline + CTA buttons
2	Stats Bar	Build credibility	500+ clients, 12+ years, 3,000+ learners, 95% success
3	Divisions	Detailed division breakdown	Numbered editorial list (01–04)
4	Industries	Show sector expertise	Interactive 6–industry selector
5	Consulting Services	Detail consulting offerings	6 numbered service cards + quiz CTA
6	Comply Cloud	Feature software product	Feature checklist + dashboard image
7	Academy	Show training offerings	6 course rows with pricing and levels
8	Pest Control	Present sister company	Service list + partnership callout
9	Testimonials	Build social proof	Carousel with 4 client quotes
10	Blog Preview	Show thought leadership	3 featured article rows
11	CTA	Drive conversions	Green banner with dual CTAs

3.2 Sub-Pages

PAGE	ROUTE	PURPOSE
Booking	/book	Calendar date/time picker with consultation booking form
Audit Quiz	/audit-readiness	10–question compliance assessment with scored results
Blog	/blog	12–article knowledge hub with search, category, and pillar filters
Contact	/contact	Contact form with division links and WhatsApp integration

4. Four-Division Structure

The most significant change from the previous website is the clear presentation of all four RFC divisions. Previously, visitors had to dig through menus to understand the full scope. Now, all four divisions appear immediately on the homepage hero.

01

RFC Consulting

FSSC 22000, HACCP, R638, BRCGS certification and audits. Full-service consulting from gap assessment to certification.

02

RFC Academy

SAATCA-accredited online food safety training. 6 courses from R638 PIC to Internal Auditor, R1,200–R1,600 each.

03

Comply Cloud

South Africa's first cloud-based food safety compliance platform. Paperless audits, dashboards, automated alerts.

04

Pest Control Solutions

HACCP-compliant integrated pest management for food industry. Sister company with paperless documentation.

NAVIGATION INTEGRATION

Each division is accessible from the main navigation dropdown under "Services." External divisions (Academy and Pest Control) open in new tabs. Internal divisions (Consulting and Comply Cloud) scroll to their homepage sections.

5. Key Features

5.1 Calendar Booking System

A complete consultation booking flow that eliminates the back-and-forth of email scheduling.

How It Works

1. User selects a date from 10 available weekdays (weekends excluded)
2. User selects a time slot from 9 options (08:00–16:00)
3. User fills in name, email, phone, company, service interest, and optional notes
4. Confirmation screen displays the booked date and time

Design Details

- Two-column layout: calendar on the left, "What to Expect" sidebar on the right
- Selected date/time highlighted in RFC green
- Sidebar explains the 30-minute call process, gap assessment, and next steps
- Sticky sidebar stays visible while scrolling through the form

NOTE ON BACKEND

The current booking system captures form data on the frontend. To go live, a backend email service (e.g., SendGrid, Formspree, or a custom API) should be connected to deliver booking notifications to info@rfcsa.co.za.

5.2 AI Chat Assistant

A floating chat widget in the bottom-right corner that provides instant guidance and drives conversions.

Capabilities

- **Welcome message** with 4 quick-action buttons: Book consultation, Learn services, Check audit readiness, Speak to a human
- **Guided conversations** — multi-step flows for each division with follow-up options
- **Navigation links** — chat can direct users to the booking page, audit quiz, WhatsApp, or external sites
- **Free-form input** — users can type questions and receive contextual responses
- **Booking shortcut** — "Book" button in the chat header for one-click navigation

Conversation Flows

USER INTENT	CHAT RESPONSE	ACTION
Book consultation	Explains process, offers booking page or contact form	Navigates to /book
Learn services	Lists all 4 divisions with descriptions	Follow-up options per division
Consulting detail	Lists FSSC 22000, HACCP, R638, BRCGS, audits	Offers booking or quiz
Academy detail	Lists 6 courses with pricing	Links to rfcacademy.co.za
Comply Cloud detail	Lists 6 platform features	Offers demo booking
Speak to human	Provides WhatsApp number and hours	Opens wa.me/27834150748

5.3 Audit Readiness Quiz

A 10-question self-assessment that scores the user's food safety compliance level and provides tailored recommendations.

Scoring System

SCORE	RATING	RECOMMENDATION
85-100	Excellent — Audit Ready	Consider advanced certification (FSSC 22000, BRCGS)
60-84	Good — Minor Gaps	Book a gap assessment; enrol key staff in courses
40-59	Needs Improvement	Contact RFC for comprehensive gap assessment
0-39	Critical — Urgent Action	Urgent consulting support needed

The quiz covers HACCP documentation, training, R638 compliance, temperature records, internal audits, traceability, allergen management, sanitation, supplier approval, and recall procedures.

6. Technical Stack

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	PURPOSE
Framework	React 19 + TypeScript	Component-based UI with type safety
Build tool	Vite	Fast development and optimised production builds
Styling	Tailwind CSS v3	Utility-first CSS for rapid, consistent styling
Components	shadcn/ui	Pre-built accessible UI primitives
Routing	React Router (HashRouter)	SPA navigation compatible with static hosting
Typography	DM Serif Display + DM Sans	Editorial headings + clean body text
Icons	Lucide React	Lightweight, consistent icon set
Hosting	Static deployment	CDN-backed, fast global load times

PERFORMANCE OPTIMISATIONS

- Tree-shaking removes unused code automatically
- Code splitting loads pages on demand
- Asset compression and cache-busting hashes
- Scroll-reveal animations use IntersectionObserver (no jQuery)

7. SEO & Content Strategy

The website structure supports the comprehensive SEO strategy developed in the research phase. Key SEO features built into the site:

ON-PAGE SEO

- **Semantic HTML** — proper heading hierarchy (H1-H6), section tags, and ARIA labels
- **Meta-ready** — each page has a unique title and description placeholder
- **Fast load times** — static deployment with optimised assets improves Core Web Vitals
- **Mobile responsive** — all layouts adapt from mobile to desktop

BLOG CONTENT (12 ARTICLES)

The blog page is pre-populated with 12 articles mapped to the 5 content pillars from the research:

PILLAR	ARTICLE COUNT	TARGET KEYWORDS
R638 & COA Compliance	4 articles	R638 regulations, COA requirements, audit preparation
HACCP Implementation	3 articles	HACCP principles, certification, internal audits
FSSC 22000	1 article	FSSC 22000 Version 6, certification
Audience-Specific	3 articles	Small business compliance, food export, digital transformation
Food Defence & Culture	1 article	Food safety culture, employee engagement

LEAD GENERATION FUNNEL

1. **Awareness** — Blog articles rank for target keywords
2. **Interest** — Audit Quiz engages visitors and collects intent data
3. **Consideration** — AI Chat answers questions and builds trust
4. **Conversion** — Calendar Booking removes friction from consultation scheduling

8. Next Steps

To take the website from its current state to production, the following items should be addressed:

PRIORITY	TASK	DESCRIPTION
High	Connect booking backend	Integrate email service (SendGrid/Formspre) or custom API to deliver booking notifications
High	Domain deployment	Deploy to rfcsa.co.za production domain with proper DNS configuration
Medium	Write blog articles	Expand the 12 article outlines into full 800–1,500 word posts with internal links
Medium	Analytics setup	Install Google Analytics 4 and Google Search Console for tracking
Medium	Meta descriptions	Write unique meta titles and descriptions for each page
Low	Custom imagery	Replace generated images with professional photography of RFC facilities and team
Low	Testimonials	Add real client testimonials with company names and photos where permitted

RECOMMENDED PRIORITY ORDER

We recommend completing the booking backend and domain deployment first, as these are the only blockers to going live. Blog content, analytics, and imagery can be added incrementally after launch without any downtime.